Fennel and the Big Blue Sad

A story about feeling sad

by KUZU NOHA

Fennel and the Big Blue Sad

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For every little bear
with a big feeling.

Fennel Bear had a kite so blue,

it zoomed and zipped the whole day through.

He ran up the hill with the wind in his face,

and the kite climbed high into sky-blue space.

Then WHOOSH! A gust,
and the string slipped free.

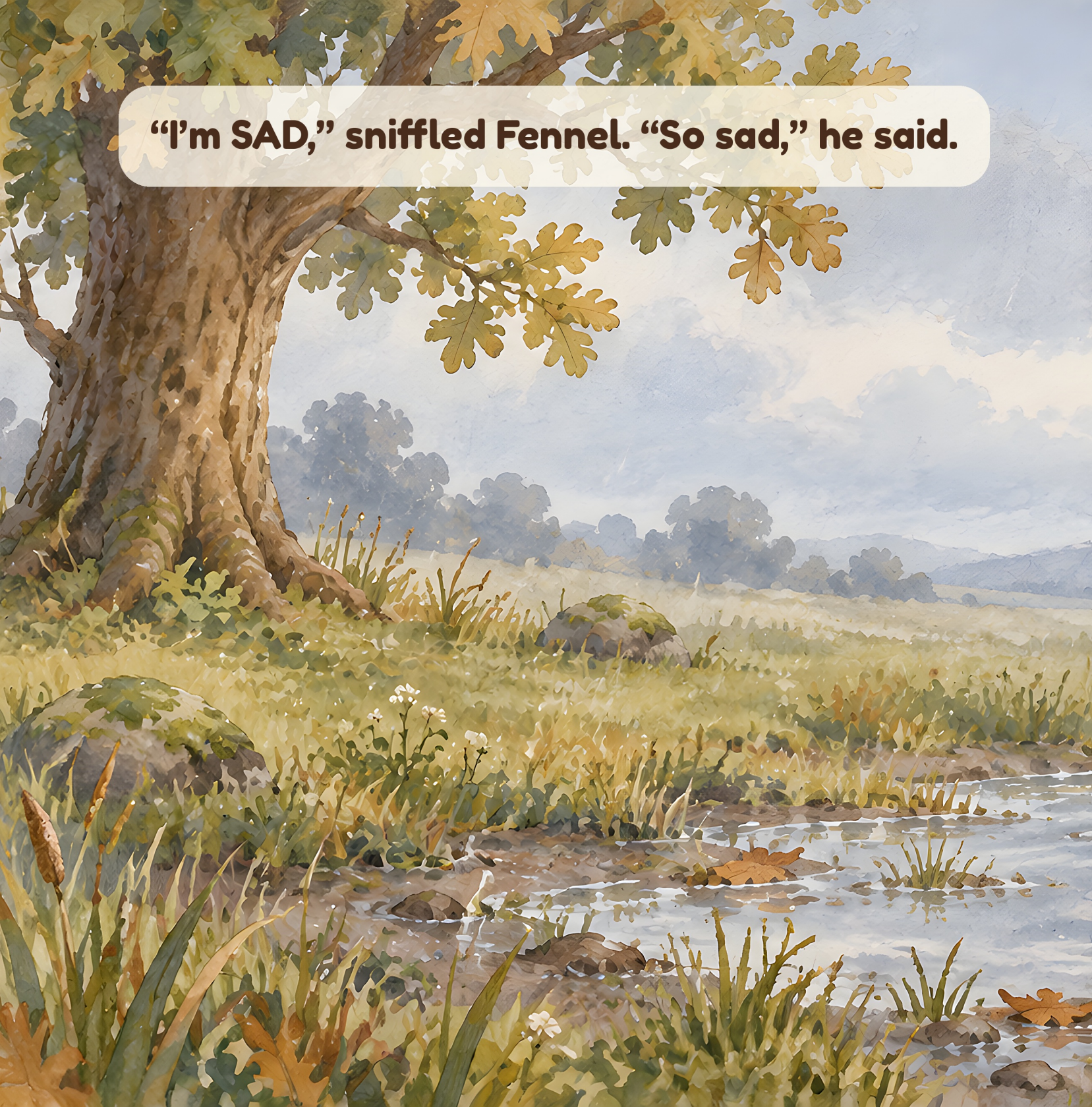
Away flew the kite, past the tall oak tree.

Fennel stood still, as still as a stone,

with a heavy, achy feeling, all alone.

A tear rolled down, then two, then three,

till a big blue puddle grew round his knees.


“I’m SAD,” sniffled Fennel. “So sad,” he said.

“The Big Blue Sad is inside my head.”

Mama Bear sat down right by his side.

“Sad is okay,” she said. “No need to hide.”

“First, NOTICE it. Where does sad sit?

In your tummy? Your chest? Just point to it.”

“Next, CRY. Let the rain come out.

Tears help wash the sad about.”

“Last, CUDDLE, snuggly, slow and tight.”

Mama’s big hug made the puddle shrink right.

The puddle got smaller,
and smaller, and small,

and the sun peeked out, warm over all.

Now when big blues come,
Fennel knows what to do:

Notice. Cry. Cuddle. The sun comes back through.

Fennel's 3 Gentle Steps

1. NOTICE

Where does sad sit? Point to it.

2. CRY

Let the rain come out.

3. CUDDLE

A hug helps. Ask for one.

Sad is okay.

It rains, and then the sun comes back.

A Note for Grown-Ups

Name the feeling: “You feel sad.”

Sit close. You do not need to fix it.

Let tears happen, then offer a hug.

Say: “Sad is okay. It will pass.”

Thank you for reading!

If Fennel helped your little one, a short review on Amazon helps other families find this book.